Bo Pre ½ Marathon Plan

(carb load/hydration, sleep pre-event, race day fueling/hydration, pacing, foot/body care)

Carb Loading (brief overview)
Why carb load? Sufficient carb intake will allow you to top off your intramuscular glycogen stores. Glycogen is the preferred fuel source for endurance performance, especially when done at a higher intensity (time trials, etc) and/or multi day events with suboptimal intra-event fueling.

By increasing your carb intake going into this day, as well as dialing back your training the days leading in (taper), we'll ensure your stores are topped off. To avoid too much water retention/inflammation/GI distress (you'll gain a bit of weight, expect it), it's best practice to dial back your fat intake during the carb load.

Intra event glucose: While glycogen fuels the muscles, glucose (the circulating form of glycogen) fuels the nervous system AND delays the use of intra-muscular glycogen. Topped off glycogen combined with circulating glucose will ensure your nervous system AND muscles are working at max capacity, as well as delaying the use of glycogen. Peri-event (in this case, pre and during) fueling is key for optimal performance (intra-run fueling guidelines below).

Carb Load Mistakes
-Eating meals at the wrong time (see recs in your plan below)
-Not decreasing fat intake (too much of calorie surplus)
-Eating foods you don't typically eat (introducing new variables is playing with fire)
-Carb loading for too long or too short (~36h is great for a 1/2 marathon)

Your carb load strategy

*don't feel like you need to hit these right on the dot, hence the range. The main theme is carbs cranked, fat low

Thu 6 Nov (partial carb load day)
Protein: 150-160G
Fat: . 30-40G
Carb: 500-550G (ideally consume 60-70%%+ of this in afternoon/evening)

Fri 7 Nov (full carb load day)
Protein: 125-135G
Fat: 20-30G
Carb: 650-700G

Sat 8 Nov (race day)

- B-fast pre-race: 3hr pre start time, 100-150G carbs, 25-40G protein UNDER 10G Fat, Under 5G fiber
- Pre-race hydration: with/around breakfast, 16-24oz water w/ electrolytes (assuming you'll also have some coffee). From there, sip periodically (up to another ~12Oz, or till your piss is straw color—favoring more clear than yellow). A lot of people over-do this. Be reasonable with it. Consider coffee if that's your usual routine, especially if it helps you poop (pre race poop is essential

*(e.g. rice krispies with non-fat milk & whey, a banana and some honey on top)

- 10-15 min pre-race: gel packet or gummy w/ ~25-40G carbs (no fat, protein or fiber)

*Biggest Carb Meal on Friday (if able): **Early Evening** (~175-225 grams)
Try not to eat this meal too late (2-4PM = optimal). More carbs/food after this meal is fine, just in smaller doses.

Suggestions for carb load days (highlighted yellow = HIGHLY suggested)
1. **Eat smaller meals, but more frequently** - high carbs can lead to feeling lethargic following big feedings. I suggest eating at least 4 meals and 1-2 snacks, or 5-6 meals
2. **Do not introduce any new foods** (carbs or otherwise - exceptions include moving to leaner meats that you normally eat fattier versions of, changing egg to egg white ratio, sipping juice/gatorade, etc).
3. **Minimize the "2 Fs"-fat & fiber** (especially day prior/even more especially day of). Be very mindful of your fat intake - very lean meats (chicken breast, 99/1 turkey, 96/4 beef), egg whites, whey, non fat yogurt, etc. Be aware of the **"sneaky fats"** like cooking oils/butter, sauces, etc.
4. Be **liberal with salt** on your foods
5. **Do not eat out/takeout** (even if it's food you normally eat—SMASH a pizza and/or a burger AFTER you crush it😂)
6. **Walk for 5-15 min after meals** (you may feel a bit sluggish post meal, this can help)

Best foods for carb load (again, choose ONLY foods you eat regularly):
1. White rice (hands down easiest digesting/least bloating/filling - just ensure it's mixed with some protein and/or fat)

2. Potatoes (great option but more filling - if you're going to eat potatoes, bake them so they don't take on a bunch of water from boiling - this will just make them more filling)
3. Sourdough bread/bagels/english muffin (best digesting bread)
4. Rice based cereals (rice n' grinds, chex, rice krispies, cream of rice)
5. Pasta (any that you're used to/digest well)
6. Fruit (mostly low fiber fruits like bananas, melons, applesauce)
7. If you're struggling to eat enough, Dried fruit (any) is excellent and/or fruit juice (100% juice) are your best buds. Gatorade is also fine - no need to water it down during carb load

Hydration Recs

Total water intake on 7 & 8 Nov
~½ oz per pound of bodyweight (no need to over-do it - **EVERYTHING besides alcohol counts towards water**)
Consider mixing salt or an electrolyte supplement into ~¼ of your water, or at least putting plenty of salt on your food
Consider a magnesium glycinate supplement (300-500MG) pre-bed the night prior to help with optimal muscle relaxation for sleep, and performance the next day. (don't use magnesium oxide, it's usually a GI nightmare).
Suggested: Morning and evening water containing electrolytes (**ESPECIALLY evening** - this will allow you to not be up all night pissing)
Looking for: Straw colored urine (if it's clear, drink less, if it's yellow, or brown drink more)

Hydration mistakes
Drinking way **too much plain water**. See urine monitoring tips above
Drinking **too much in the evening** before bed (sleep is paramount - you'll have time to hydrate pre event)
Not counting **other beverages** (coffee, juice, diet drinks) towards your water intake. These things count.
Chugging water a few times during the day instead of just sipping it throughout the whole day
Forgetting to drink enough pre/during race, OR **drinking way too much** during/between

Miscellaneous Considerations

Pacing/RPE/HR:

This is where trusting your training shines bright—run pace data, RPE/mindfulness, heart rate, etc. You'll see EVERYONE and their brother in law (twice removed) take off at a break neck pace out the gate. Do your best to stay disciplined and run your race.

Since the course is virtually ½ uphill, ½ downhill, you'll want to be more conservative to start.

I don't know the exact grade, so I'll give you a range—but basically, you'll want it to feel somewhere between tempo and zone 2 for the first ~⅔ of the race, then tempo till you're about a mile from finishing. Last mile, go for broke (if still capable).

Ballpark first ~½ (6-7 mi) pace: 8:10-8:30 on flats, 8:30-9:00 on inclines, 7:45-8:00 on slight declines (there should be a few sprinkled in).

Ballpark back ~½ (6-7 mi) pace: 7:50-8:10 (slower for periodic inclines). START the back ½ conservatively even though it's mostly downhill. Going too hot will be tempting, but it'll shred your quads, making extreme soreness a potential limiter (rather than cardio).

RPE: 6-7 in the 1st ⅓, 7-8 in the middle ⅓, 8-9 to finish off last 1/3.

Heart rate (just proxies to check yourself, don't get too wrapped around the axle): Zone 3 for 1st ~⅔ of race, teetering zone 4 at times. Zone 4, teetering zone 5 for last ~⅓

Note: this could ALL go out the window on race day since running is such a crap shoot. Sometimes things go as planned, other times they don't. Do your best to enjoy the experience and don't beat yourself up if things don't go as planned.

Cramping: Cramps are normal and should be expected, especially late in the race. If you don't cramp at all, consider it a pleasant surprise. Since you'll be going harder than normal and in a stressed out state of adrenaline, cramps may occur. Do not freak out. If you're able, bring a 'hot shot' or 'pickle juice shot' for emergency cramp use (they have these at REI/other outdoor/running stores, or amazon). Just down them if you cramp, and the sharp taste can help it go away. Spice (as well as bitterness) can trick your nervous system into relaxing, and can be a good way to alleviate acute cramping.

Cramps usually occur in: hamstrings, adductors, quads, calves

In any event, **DO NOT start slamming more water.** If you follow the hydration plan laid out above, your cramps are very unlikely stemming from lack of hydration (more likely

overworked musculature). You can still sip water/hydration concoction as planned, but overdoing it will just make the situation worse. You may need to slow down a bit, change your gait, stop and stretch for 30 seconds, or do some form of improvisation to keep going while the cramps are happening. Typically, they go away with time/improvisation.

Body Care:
Chaffage - I suggest putting body glide or 2toms sport shield in the following areas:
-taint/nutsack/inner thighs/maybe ass crack
-nipples, unless going tarps off (tape works fine too)

Fueling Supplement Options:
****Whatever you've been using trumps anything listed below****
Good ole gatorade (⅔ gatorade, ⅓ water).
*Note: Sodium concentration in gatorade is shit, so I would add classic iodized salt to it (~500-600mg per 24 oz mix)
Tailwind (mix according to label instructions/what you have for water sources)
Gels (use ones you're used to—note caffeine vs non-caffeine)
Chews (hard to eat during hard runs, but if you're used to them, totally fine. Note caffeine/non caffeine)

Intra-race fuel: Aim for 2-3 gels or 50-75G carbs/hr (mix of liquid/gels/gu's), or whatever you've been doing in training. Don't introduce any new carb numbers/supplements on race day. E.g. every 20 min, take a gel (or equivalent)

Intra Run Hydration: go for ~16-24oz/hr with 750-1000mg sodium. If you're not used to this quantity (from training) titrate down as needed.

Other options: salt tabs, caffeine tabs, sour patch kids or similar candy

Let me know if you have questions. Go smash!